

Members of the Tenure & Promotion Committee
Caldwell University
Caldwell, NJ 07006

August 4, 2026

Dear Committee Members,

I am writing this letter in support of Professor Vlad Veksler and his application for promotion to Associate Professor.

I have had the pleasure of working closely and partnering with Vlad on multiple occasions and projects here at Caldwell University. He is always easy to collaborate with and our projects are always successful.

We worked together to establish his COG-AI lab in a space in Jennings Library. Although the lab was there for only 2 years (2023-2024), I was able to see Vlad's strong work ethic and his commitment to and passion for this project. Vlad communicated his vision and needs clearly and openly with me and we were able to easily work together to accomplish our goal of securing the space. Vlad continued to be hands-on but eventually supervised and gave his students the responsibility to build out the space with equipment and posters. Those students thrived with the autonomy that Vlad gave them. They were just as serious and respectful as their mentor and they learned, built and created in that space. The lab was able to move to an upgraded space in another building on campus but Vlad and I have continued to collaborate and share resources.

Vlad was also instrumental in helping us create and establish the VR Lounge in Jennings Library. He helped with researching the equipment and met with us and IT to recommend technical needs in the space.

We also called on Vlad to help organize and sunset older Computer Science books as part of our 5 year weeding / deselection project. He quickly came in, heard our requests and advised us on criteria he felt was an important part of the process. He then did the physical work of deselecting the books. This all led to successfully updating the Computer Science print book collection for students and faculty.

My staff and I responded to Vlad requesting us to present library services at the New Faculty and New Adjunct Orientations. Vlad was direct and easy to communicate with and ran efficient but warm events that created community instantly.

Vlad is an incredibly intelligent and knowledgeable faculty member and his enthusiasm to do good things here at Caldwell is contagious. I hope to continue to work with him long into the future.

Please consider Vlad for promotion so Caldwell University can continue to benefit from his knowledge, experience and drive.

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Victoria Swanson', with a stylized, flowing script.

Victoria Swanson

Library Director, Jennings Library

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